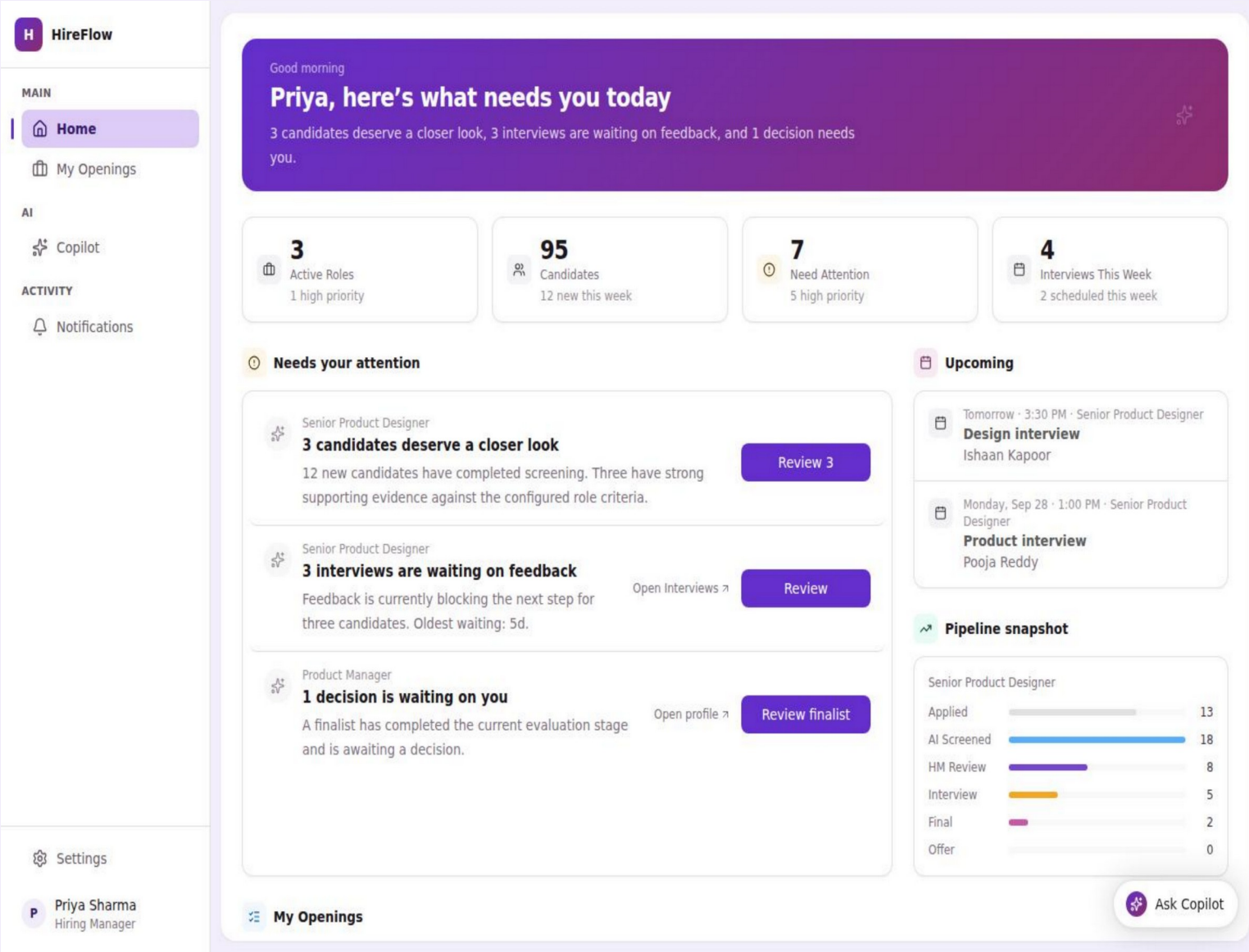


Reimagining candidate review

ATS → AI-native, chat-first

A hiring workspace where the manager can ask, investigate, decide and act - while evidence stays structured and decisions stay human.



The brief was about the interaction shift

Reimagine candidate review for a hiring manager - not simply redesign an ATS.

01

**New candidate
notification**

02

**Review one
candidate in
depth**

03

**See the overall
pipeline**

WHAT THE EXERCISE TESTS

- Rethink the interaction - do not bolt chat onto old screens.
- Know what belongs in conversation vs structured UI.
- Show the reasoning, key decisions and AI working process.

DESIGN QUESTION

**If the ATS already has
the data,
what should AI remove
from the manager's
cognitive load?**

The opportunity was interpretation and
action - not another dashboard.

We researched current ATS + AI recruiting patterns

We reviewed four products to understand what already works and where the interaction could move further.

- | | | | |
|----|-------------------|------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Greenhouse | Structure + control | Scorecards, candidate workflow and pipeline gave us a reference for transparent, structured review. |
| 02 | Ashby | Criteria-led AI | AI-assisted review showed the value of tying recommendations to explicit hiring criteria. |
| 03 | Eightfold | Matching intelligence | Useful for AI screening and matching patterns - but ranking alone did not feel like a new interaction model. |
| 04 | Paradox | Conversation + action | Showed how conversation can move recruiting work forward, not only answer questions. |

What we took forward / Keep structured evidence and pipeline control. Use AI to reduce navigation and interpretation.

Meet Priya - our Hiring Manager

Hiring is one responsibility among many. She may own several openings at the same time.

PERSONA

Priya

Hiring Manager

3 active roles

95 candidates

7 need attention

CORE JOB

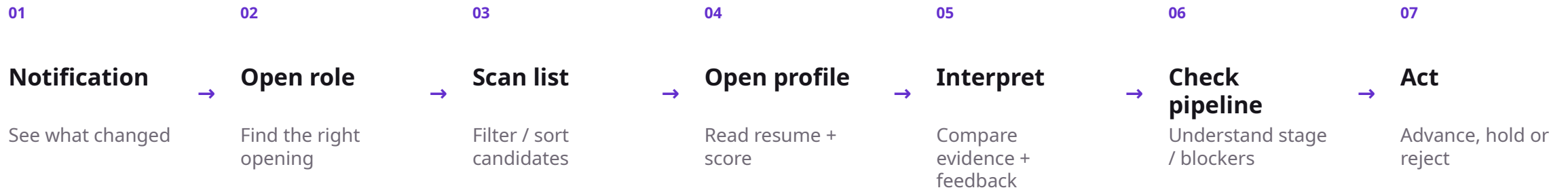
“Help me understand who deserves my attention, why, and what I need to do next.”

She is not trying to manage records. She is trying to make good hiring decisions with limited attention.

What changed? Who is worth reviewing? What am I missing? Where is hiring stuck?

Priya's current journey

The ATS contains the information, but Priya still assembles the meaning herself.



The friction is not missing data.

It is the repeated navigation and interpretation required before Priya can decide what deserves attention.

That becomes harder when she is switching between multiple openings.

Where the current experience breaks down

01

ATTENTION FRAGMENTATION

Notifications report activity, but do not tell Priya what deserves attention.

02

REPEATED NAVIGATION

Lists, profiles, resumes, feedback and pipeline stages live across separate views.

03

OPAQUE RECOMMENDATIONS

A score can rank candidates without showing the evidence or uncertainty behind it.

04

MANUAL INTERPRETATION

The ATS organizes hiring data; Priya still turns that data into a decision.

Reframing the experience

The shift is from navigation-first to intent-first - without removing structured UI.

TRADITIONAL

**Navigate → Filter → Inspect →
Decide → Act**

AI-NATIVE

**Ask → Investigate → Understand →
Decide → Confirm → Execute**

WHAT SURVIVES

Candidate list · resume · filters ·
pipeline · hiring actions

WHAT CHANGES

Dashboard → brief
Profile → evidence workspace
Pipeline → diagnosis

WHAT DISAPPEARS

Repeated screen hopping
Opaque AI scores
Hidden AI filtering

Chat for intent. UI for evidence. Human for decisions.

Assumptions kept the prototype focused

Enough product context to test the interaction - without designing the entire recruiting suite.

01 Roles already exist Job creation is outside the prototype.

02 Criteria are configured Each role has a JD, scorecard, screening questions and priorities.

03 Candidate evidence exists Resume, application, screening, skills, feedback, stage and activity are available.

04 AI is grounded Recommendations use configured criteria + candidate evidence.

05 Priya owns multiple openings Global, role and candidate context all matter.

06 Exploration is temporary Conversational lenses do not silently rewrite official criteria.

07 Actions require control Consequential or external actions require explicit confirmation.

08 Prototype data is fictional Representative candidates and scenarios are used to test the experience.

One product state. Three ways to work.

Manual, conversational and hybrid routes operate the same hiring data and actions.

CONVERSATIONAL

Ask → review → refine → decide
→ confirm → execute



HYBRID

Ask AI → inspect structured
result → filter → ask again → act



MANUAL

Navigate → filter → inspect →
decide → act



SHARED HIRING STATE

Roles · Candidates · Filters · Evidence · Pipeline stages · Activity · Actions

Copilot is not another database or another mode. It reads and updates the same state as the structured product.

Visible context: Global / Senior Product Designer / Ananya Rao

01 Notification → prioritization

The first required moment became a hiring brief rather than a notification feed.

THE PROBLEM

“12 new applicants” still leaves Priya with 12 decisions about where to start.

Across multiple openings, a notification creates another task unless the system can interpret what changed against the role's configured criteria.

DESIGN DECISION

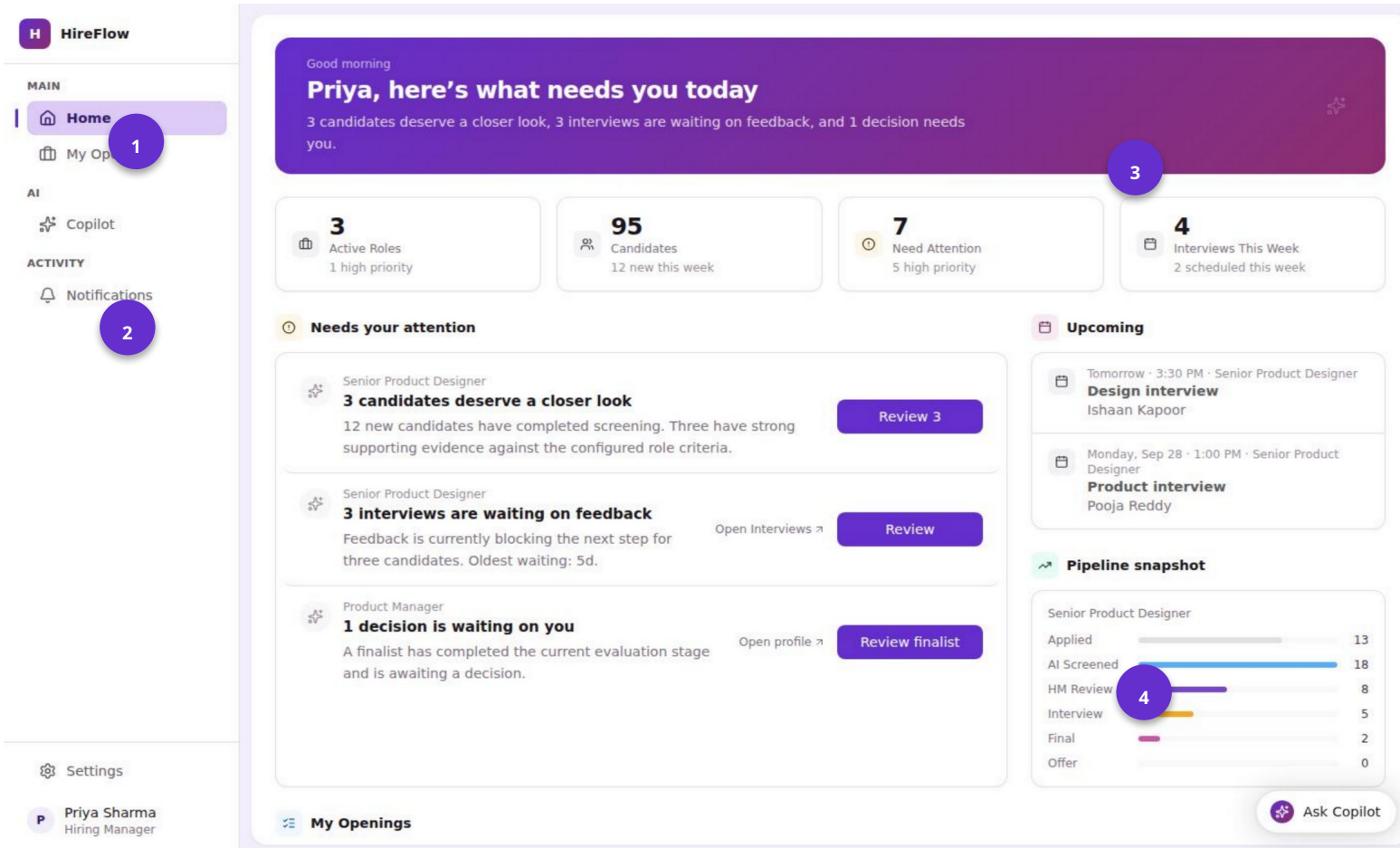
Start with attention, not inventory.

- Surface candidates and blockers that deserve attention.
- Explain why they surfaced.
- Keep the complete candidate pool accessible.
- Let Priya review directly, ask Copilot, or navigate manually.

AI narrows the work - not the options.

The home view becomes a daily hiring brief

The screen tells Priya what needs attention first, while keeping her openings and pipeline visible.



1

Attention before inventory

Needs-attention items lead the page.

2

Reason, not just alert

Each surfaced item explains why it matters.

3

Cross-role awareness

Interviews and decisions across openings remain visible.

4

Multiple next steps

Review, ask Copilot, or open the structured view.

02 Candidate profile → evidence workspace

The second required moment became an investigation surface - not a scorecard with a verdict.

THE PROBLEM

A recommendation is useful only if Priya can understand what supports it - and what is still unknown.

A numeric score alone can look authoritative. Missing evidence can also be mistaken for negative evidence.

DESIGN DECISION

Make the recommendation inspectable.

- Lead with “Strong match · 4/5 priorities supported”.
- Keep the numeric AI score secondary.
- Show evidence by configured criterion.
- Expose uncertainty and “needs validation”.
- Keep resume, skills, experience and activity available.

Evidence before authority

The recommendation and its evidence live in the same workspace where Priya can verify the candidate.

H

HireFlow

MAIN

Home

My Openings

AI

Copilot

ACTIVITY

Notifications

Settings

P

Priya Sharma

Hiring Manager

Senior Product Designer > Candidates > Ananya Rao

AR

Ananya Rao

HM Review

Senior Product Designer · Northstar AI
Bengaluru · 7 yrs experience · Source: LinkedIn

Download resume

Hold

Advance to Interview

...

Strong match

4 / 5 priorities supported

AI screening score 87

AI Assessment

Evidence

Resume

Profile

Details

Criteria

Activity

Enterprise SaaS experience

High

Designed complex B2B SaaS experiences used by enterprise operations teams. Worked on p...

Show details & source

Strong

Complex workflow design

High

Led redesigns involving multi-step configuration, approvals and operational workflows.

Show details & source

Strong

AI product experience

High

Designed AI-assisted workflows for an enterprise intelligence product. Worked on experience...

Show details & source

Strong

Design systems

Medium

Contributed reusable patterns and components to an established enterprise design system. E...

Show details & source

Good

Leadership / ownership

Medium

Resume references leading initiatives and cross-functional work, but available information do...

Show details & source

Unclear

Criteria marked Unclear or Insufficient evidence reflect missing information, not a negative finding. Missing evidence is never treated as

Ask Copilot

Senior Product Designer / Ananya Rao

1

Evidence against configured criteria

Assessment is tied to the role's priorities.

2

Strongest evidence surfaced

The clearest supporting evidence appears first.

3

Needs validation is explicit

Unknown evidence stays uncertain - not negative.

4

Source remains accessible

Evidence can be checked against resume or experience.

HireFlow / 13

Conversation without losing candidate context

Some questions are faster to ask than to navigate. The candidate and conversation stay visible together.

The screenshot displays the HireFlow interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Home, My Openings, Copilot, and Notifications. The main area shows the candidate profile for Ananya Rao, a Senior Product Designer. The profile includes a 'Download resume' button, a 'Hold' button, and a 'Move to Interview' button. Below the profile, there is a section for 'AI Assessment' with a 'Strong match' status and an 'AI screening score 87'. The 'Activity' tab is selected, showing a timeline of events: 'Candidate surfaced for Hiring Manager review' (9:28 PM), 'AI screening completed' (9:26 PM), and 'Application received' (5:26 PM) from LinkedIn.

On the right, a Copilot chat window is open, titled 'Senior Product Designer / Ananya Rao'. The chat window contains the following text:

Ask about candidates, evidence or recommendations for Senior Product Designer / Ananya Rao.

Why Ananya?

Move Ananya to Interview

At the bottom of the chat window is an input field with the placeholder text 'Ask Copilot about your hiring...' and an 'Ask' button.

Numbered callouts 1 through 4 are placed on the chat window to highlight specific features:

1. Visible inherited context
2. Investigate in place
3. Same conversation can act
4. Structured evidence stays visible

03 Pipeline status → diagnosis + action

The third required moment keeps the visual pipeline and adds interpretation.

THE PROBLEM

A pipeline shows where candidates are. It does not automatically explain where hiring is stuck.

Priya still has to scan stages, time-in-stage and pending feedback to understand what needs action.

DESIGN DECISION

Keep the board. Add diagnosis.

- Surface the current bottleneck.
- Call out candidates waiting too long.
- Identify what is waiting specifically on Priya.
- Let Copilot investigate blockers or prepare the next action.

The pipeline stays visual; AI explains what needs attention

Spatial UI remains the fastest way to scan stages. AI adds the interpretation layer.

HireFlow

MAIN

- Home
- My Openings**

AI

- Copilot

ACTIVITY

- Notifications

Settings

Priya Sharma
Hiring Manager

← My Openings > Senior Product Designer

Senior Product Designer • Active

46 candidates 12 new since last review 5 need attention

Overview Candidates 46 Pipeline Interviews Criteria 5

Pipeline

Where every active candidate for this role stands right now.

Interview is the current bottleneck — 3 candidates have been waiting 4+ days. Nisha Verma has been pending on you for 5 days.

Ask Copilot Review blockers

APPLIED 13

- Sana Khan**
 - Needs more information
 - 6 yrs · Bengaluru · 6d in stage

View 12 more →

AI SCREENED 18

- Arjun Nair**
 - Potential match
 - 9 yrs · Hyderabad · 3d in stage
- Kavya Iyer**
 - Potential match
 - 6 yrs · Bengaluru · 4d in stage
- Vikram Singh**
 - Potential match
 - 8 yrs · Pune · 4d in stage
- Dev Malhotra**
 - Potential match
 - 7 yrs · Delhi · 5d in stage

View 14 more →

HM REVIEW 8

- Ananya Rao**
 - Strong match 4/5
 - 7 yrs · Bengaluru · Today in stage
- Rahul Mehta**
 - Strong match 4/5
 - 8 yrs · Bengaluru · 1d in stage
- Meera Shah**
 - Promising 3/5
 - 5 yrs · Mumbai · 2d in stage

View 5 more →

INTERVIEW 1

1 waiting on your feedback

- Nisha Verma**
 - 5d in stage
 - Feedback needed
- Rohan Das**
 - 4d in stage
 - Waiting on another interviewer · 4d
- Tara Menon**
 - 4d in stage
 - Waiting on another interviewer · 4d
- Ishaan Kapoor**
 - 2d in stage
 - Interview scheduled

Ask Copilot Senior Product Designer / Pipeline 2d in stage

1 Stage visibility stays intact

The board remains the primary scan surface.

2 Bottleneck insight

AI explains where progress is slowing.

3 Time-in-stage becomes actionable

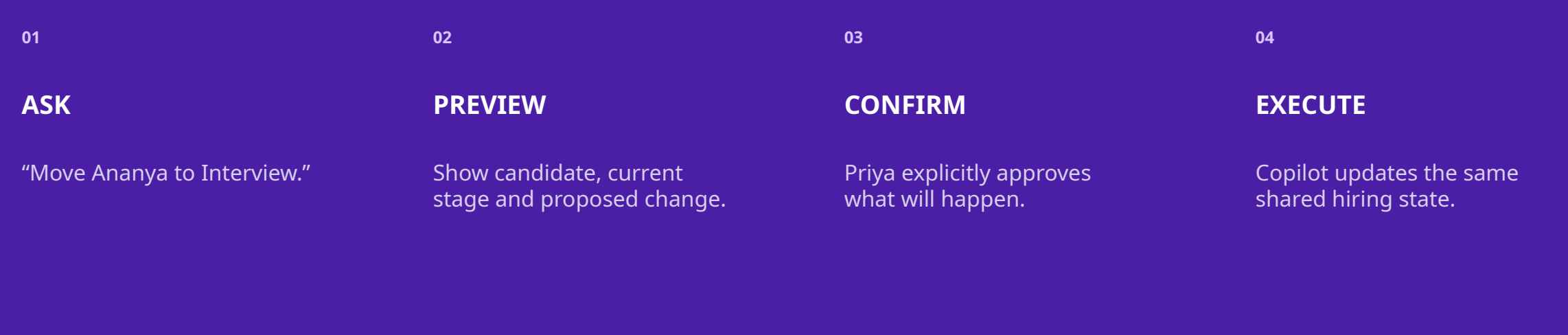
Waiting candidates are easier to spot.

4 Action path stays contextual

Review blockers or ask Copilot from the same role.

From decision to action

Copilot can operate the ATS - but consequential actions stay explicit.



Human control

Priya keeps decision authority. After confirmation, Copilot can execute the operation - she does not have to manually repeat the same action in the UI.

Before building the prototype, I created product context

I used AI as a design + prototyping partner, but first gave it stable documents to reason from.

01

UXRD.md

Defined persona, problem, scope, journeys, requirements and interaction principles.

Why: keep the product definition stable across iterations.

[OPEN DOCUMENT](#) 

02

AI_BEHAVIOR.md

Defined Copilot context, evidence, uncertainty, filters, actions and confirmation rules.

Why: AI behaviour is part of the UX and needed explicit rules.

[OPEN DOCUMENT](#) 

03

PROTOTYPE_DATA.md

Defined roles, candidates, evidence, stages and representative scenarios.

Why: keep screens and Copilot responses grounded in one dataset.

[OPEN DOCUMENT](#) 

When prompts were not enough

The functional direction was right, but the prototype started to drift without explicit build constraints.

WHAT WE FACED

The UI was not consistently following the intended hierarchy, component behaviour or shared-state model. Individual prompts fixed individual screens, but the product still felt like it was “freelancing.”

WHAT WE DID

We added engineering and UI requirement files so Claude had explicit rules for routes, shared state, actions, layout, density, responsive behaviour and component patterns.

ENGINEERING_REQUIREMENTS. md

Routes · shared state · mutations · confirmations ·
implementation guardrails

[OPEN](#) 

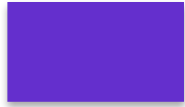
UI_REQUIREMENTS.md

Hierarchy · density · tables · navigation · Copilot surfaces ·
responsive rules

[OPEN](#) 

Then we gave the prototype a small design system

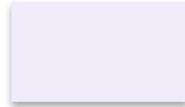
The goal was consistency across dense enterprise screens - not a large component library.



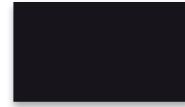
Primary / AI



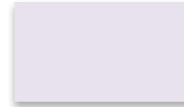
Deep accent



AI surface



Primary text



Structure

TYPOGRAPHY

Inter-style product hierarchy

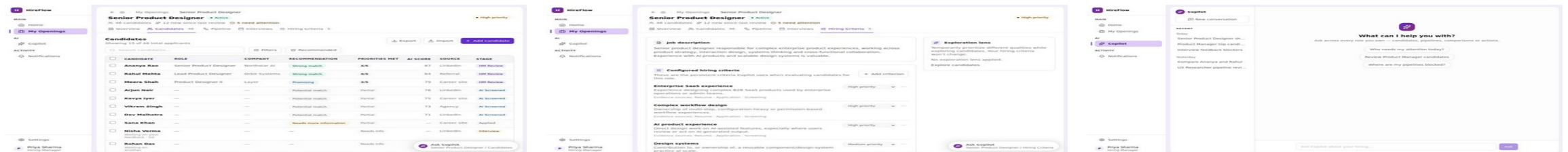
Clear page titles, compact metadata and readable tables.

COMPONENT RULES

Tables · filters · status badges · role tabs · evidence rows · confirmations

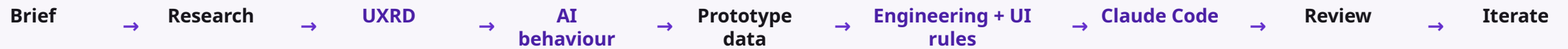
AI SURFACES

Full Copilot · docked Copilot · visible context · evidence + uncertainty states



How AI was used across the exercise

The documents became persistent context for the build instead of being re-explained in every prompt.



AI USAGE

AI was used to structure the product definition, define Copilot behaviour, generate the functional React prototype and iterate from critique. The design decisions were progressively encoded as context rather than left inside one-off prompts.

The important loop was: output → critique → identify why it failed → tighten the system → rebuild.

Deliverables

Working product, source code and the documents used to guide the prototype.

LIVE PROTOTYPE

Interactive HireFlow prototype

[OPEN](#) 

AI BEHAVIOR

Copilot rules + context model

SUBMITTED WITH CASE STUDY

UI REQUIREMENTS

Visual + responsive rules

SUBMITTED WITH CASE STUDY

UXRD

Product definition + interaction requirements

SUBMITTED WITH CASE STUDY

ENGINEERING REQUIREMENTS

Build + shared-state guardrails

SUBMITTED WITH CASE STUDY

PROMPT + ITERATION HISTORY

Selected AI working history

[OPEN](#) 

Repository link intentionally omitted from the submission deck; the live prototype and supporting design artifacts are sufficient to review the exercise.

Takeaways from reimagining the ATS

The strongest shift was not “more AI”. It was deciding where AI genuinely changes the interaction.

01 **AI-NATIVE ≠ CHAT EVERYWHERE**

Conversation is strongest for intent, investigation and changing direction. Structured UI is stronger for scanning, evidence, comparison and persistent state.

02 **REDUCE INTERPRETATION - NOT EVIDENCE**

AI can narrow attention and explain why, while the underlying candidate evidence remains available for verification.

03 **CONTEXT MUST STAY VISIBLE**

Across roles, candidates and filters, the manager should always know what the AI is reasoning over.

04 **HUMAN CONTROL ≠ MANUAL WORK**

Priya keeps decision authority. After explicit confirmation, Copilot can still execute the operation.

Takeaways from AI-first designing

AI became more useful when I stopped treating each prompt as a design request and gave it a product system to work within.

01 **Requirements were not enough**

AI also needed interaction, state, engineering and visual constraints.

02 **Documentation became executable context**

UXRDs and markdown files actively shaped the prototype - they were not only handoff artifacts.

03 **Critique mattered more than prompt volume**

The biggest improvements came from identifying why an output failed and tightening the system.

04 **AI accelerated execution, not judgment**

The designer still decides what belongs in chat, what belongs in UI and where human authority is required.

From an ATS the hiring manager operates



**to an intelligent hiring workspace they can ask,
investigate, understand and act through.**

Ask naturally. Explore freely. See structurally. Decide deliberately.